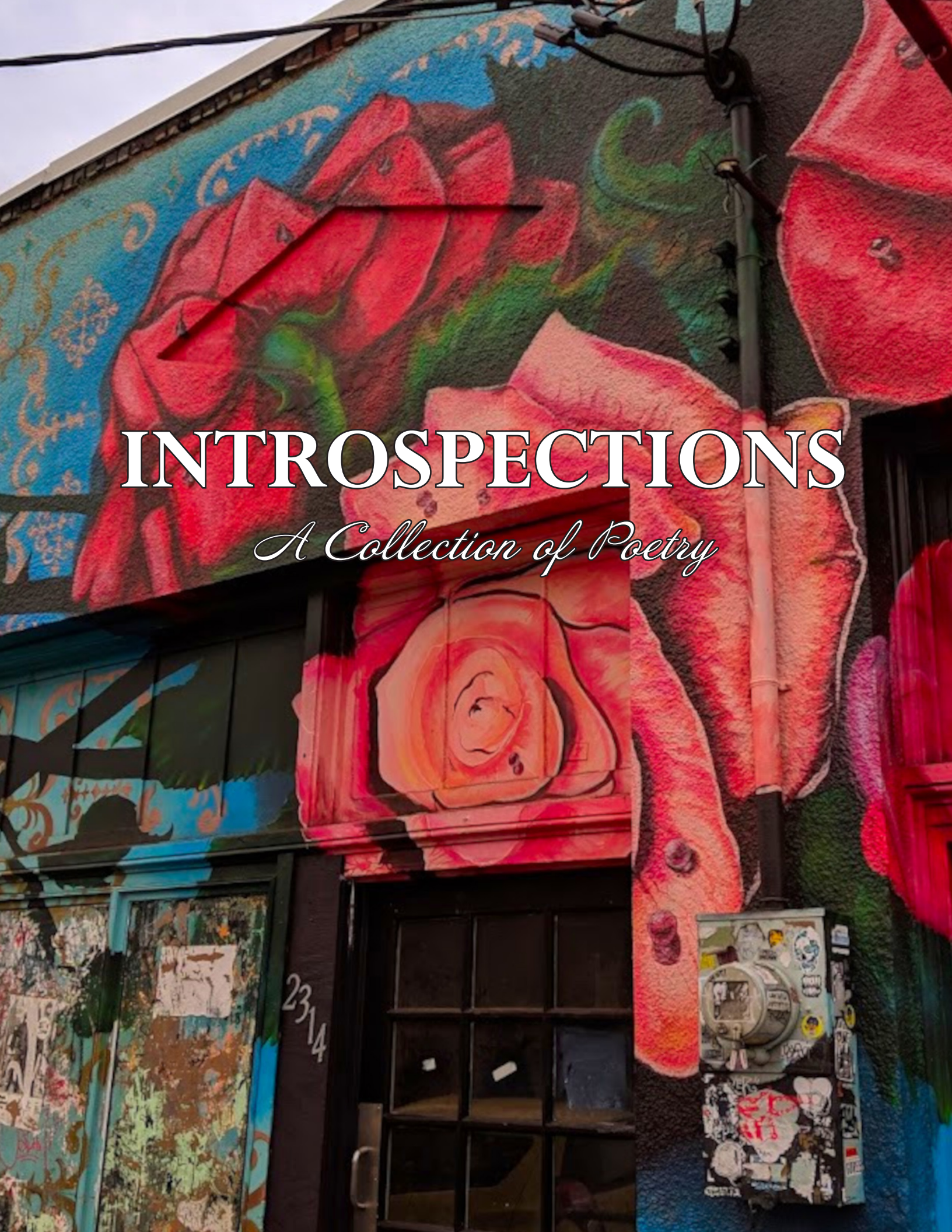

INTROSPECTIONS

A Collection of Poetry

THIS ANTHOLOGY IS DEDICATED TO R.A. REED, A MAN WHOSE LOVE I NEVER TRULY DESERVED AND YET WHO NEVER STOPPED GIVING HIS TO ME

It's Winter Now

It's winter now, I don't know how
I survived another fucking summer

It's always almost autumn
Down here at rock bottom

Mirror, mirror on this wall
What do you see as a fly on the wall?
Who would you love to see fall?
Like the leaves off the trees
amber colored just like these
dying in piles that grow and grow as they please
like defeat as you drop to your knees

I may be as wrong about them as they are about me
but since there is no way to see
laughter is my lantern, I move in the delight it sheds
on all the nothing in front of me
I hope no one cries because of me

A Way With Words

Words are ways of decorating
Everything that can be put into them
For the most part they just sort of
Float around the atmosphere
Like little easy-to-pop bubbles
Kind of making good and bad
Both look better without changing
The meaning of either

But there is a very small garden
Of select words
That is kept as hidden as
Someone's heart can hide them
Hearts are all as different
As the words planted inside them

Deep roots running from one to another
Connecting
Intersecting

Then there's those just sprouting
Sprinkled seedlings
Words with new meanings
That may be soon forgotten
Or could bloom into beautiful
Forget-me-nots

Words with weight all started out
As something that meant nothing
Something has to happen of significance
To give these words their true magnificence

A dream, A death, A scream
Within words
It's easy to lose a lot of different things
A memory could wander off inside a word
And be lost forever
Leaving the word in its place
Etched deeper into the mind it is scrawled across
Telling an entire story all by itself now

On our own scale different words
Weigh differently
You can cram enough power in a word
To destroy or inspire
If you know what you're doing
You can come pretty close
To controlling thoughts, ideas, beliefs
And even direct the traffic
Of hope and happiness

Experience something and replace it
With a one-word way to say it

When you want to revisit it

Just remember the name you re call it by

There is a pool too big to guess its size

Much too deep to know where its bottom,

If it has one, lies

The substance is mystery in liquid form

Our history in waves

On their ways into whirling pools

That swirl and elude the world

Endless unknown Sea of emptiness

A lot like the fear of an absent reflection

Staring back at you from a mirror

That cauldron of chaos is everything

That can't be said

All the things which words cannot contain

Because there is much that can only be felt

You can look as long as you want

For words to explain or describe

What the invisible part of a soul

Somehow manages to hide

Look high and low but when

You ask yourself you will always know

If you can capture it in words or not

Impressions of Depression

Sadness equals badness, they want you to believe it

I think it's absolute madness, but it's all in how you perceive it

"Something is wrong with you..."

"You have a serious medical condition"

A prescription for some pills, you and a doctor in a room

Together they will help you to get better soon

The pills will fix the imbalance in your head

The doctor will listen, and echo all you've said

I think the problem is all in your head,

Because that is exactly where they have put it

"You are suffering from depression"

That's it...?

Just remember that those who feel profoundly depressed

Are those whose happiness is likewise intense

What is so wrong with that?

The answer is nothing, but here is the catch

They want you to show up every day for work

And be a productive member of their society

If it were up to you, is this the society you'd choose?

So why should you care?

Some people care because they're scared

Of what other people might think

But not everyone fits into this puzzle

So they try to force you into the place they think you should go

Deforming the picture

A war you don't want to die for

Is one you should never be forced to fight

Prescriptions and pills are a lot like a draft

Forcing you to hand over your life and who you are

But they have turned this into a war against yourself

They are trying to quiet a part of you that wants to be loud

Instead of feeling shame, be proud

At least you feel something, not everyone does

Maybe you aren't depressed

It could just be some part of you is being oppressed

Maybe it's nothing more than stress

Maybe it's a dozen different things

Maybe you're just a mess

Out of messes come accidental works of art

Embracing everything you are is actually a great start

That means the sad parts too

If you love yourself the most at your happiest moments

There is no reason not to be fond of who you are in the dark

A lot of people won't understand this

And that's okay too

As long as you know why

The moments of despair make you even better

Then nobody else needs to

"The Great Depression," fixed in one-hour sessions

And one pill twice each day

At least that's what they say

But this is not enough to make everyone feel okay

Sometimes There is Nothing

Sometimes there is nothing
Sometimes there is no answer
Every thought you try to turn to
Disappears just as you learn to

It feels a lot like panic
A deep gasp for air
That you hold forever
Just afraid of how silent
Things are down there
In the depths of despair

It feels just like that dream
Where you can sense that something's near
But you can't run away because you're paralyzed by fear

Most of the times when I needed someone
I had no one

Most of the times when I needed something
I had nothing

And most of all those times all that I had for sure
Was everything that hurt here in my heart
Here in my head

Maybe I was always in the wrong place
At the wrong time

Maybe someone stronger could have ended up
With a mind less fucked up than mine

Things could always be worse than they are
It will get worse than it has been so far

So what do I do, what do I say
How do I make it okay?

It's so hard to find the place
Somewhere in the middle
of the best and worst I've felt

Piece of Nothing

Want a piece of my nothing?
Tiny slice to suffice
For something that's nothing
Doesn't it feel nice?

There is something that you're overlooking
I swear to god it's there,
Underneath the other part of me
The part you see

Sometimes it sends me a little shock to remind me
That at any moment it could slip away

Once upon a simplicity
That now is forever lost to me
Life was redeemable for
One happiness and that was all
To get so high and then to fall

I'm left alone, just me
Lost in losing all these memories
Each one has a heart set on escaping me

But here I am still trying
Trying to do or make something
Instead of nothing
And that's all you want

Wanna know why it doesn't even bother me?

Take it on, let it in
Either way you win
Once you've choked it down
Quiet fills up the afterwards
Of that horrible desperate sound

And then it begins to grow and to swell
Into your own private little hell
Running rampant until...

All that is left is all that you were,
I just hope you were sure
Only thing left is you and the void it grew into
That takes up the entire inside of you

Leaves as little as the leaves
Left falling from these trees

For something that's nothing,
Sure does feel nice

Parts of Me

The parts of me that hurt the worst
Want me to write something for them
But I can't, I don't know what to say
I am lost in all this sadness
And so are they

Today was a lot like yesterday
Which was a lot like the day before
We keep saying we've had enough
But we must be wrong 'cause we just
Keep on doing it more

I used to be more in control
But now I don't feel like I'm at the wheel
I'm just along for the ride a passenger
Without a driver

I'm scared of things I wasn't afraid of in the past
I guess I knew all along
That my beautiful fearlessness couldn't last

Nautical Slaughter

I wish I could look away
Like at the doctor's
When you're a kid

Sure it's what I asked for
But look at what you did

It's the most lonely place
I have ever been
And sometimes I get
Stuck there for so long
I'm just a different kind of strong

You can watch me while I'm there
But you've never been there
There is no glory, there is no pride
It's only seek so I can be denied
The chaos in my mind leaves
No room for me to hide

Even though I know what I'm
Walking into is burning down
I'm always right there in the middle
Of the same flames

It never gets better
The pain doesn't change
It only gets worse
Running on these same old veins
Sometimes I'm just what remains
Of a person still haunting their own lost life

So here I am, just like I'll spend
The rest of my forever
You were there before
So you remember when I didn't
Know this darkness
Not forgetting that you don't know
How dark it's really been

There is nothing you can say
There is nothing you can do

Without a cure there is no chance
Hoping and caring
Bleeding and bearing
Trying is lying
And screaming and swearing

There are no words for what it feels like
Feels a little like light at night
That just won't go away

I cry for me because I've watched
Myself along the way

Become the me that hurts this way

That atrocity has cost you me

But I promise that it has cost me much more

My heart is a shipwreck somewhere

I'm just what washed upon the shore

Somewhere deep under the water

You can still find the nautical slaughter

Certain seashells will forever keep inside them

The sound of those ocean waves rolling

Crashing and roaring

If it looks big enough to hold the sound

Hold it to your ear

Do the same with my heart

And the shattering is an echo

Of it breaking that you hear

The Righteous

The world won't stop
Doing what it does
People won't stop telling me
Shit I already fucking know

They seem brainwashed to me
They only see one side of things
The side they have been told,
Been shown
The only side they've ever known

Usually they didn't come up with
Any of what they are saying on their own

They hear it
Make it fit in places it doesn't
Change a couple things
That don't seem major
Turn it into a thought that
They think is their own

I don't want to know how dark
Things look to them
As they sit there telling me
How to find the fucking light
In whatever way they think
They've found it first

Wonder what the fuck
The light has done for them
Other than make them irritating
To everyone else who doesn't care
Or who has seen the light
And was unimpressed
Walked away from it like
Countless other things in life
Not worth their time

Okay, drugs will kill me
But you know what, you'll die too
Yeah, I know they are bad for me
But I figured that out by myself, without you

And your stupid variation
Off someone else's
Half-brained fucking revelation
Makes me want them
In greater amounts

I'll bet whatever belief you're
Trying to spread
Would seem stupid to you too
If you weren't surrounded
By other sad creatures
Who are spouting off about it too

Standing right there
Next to you
Helping you feel sure of who you are

Sorry, but that faith doesn't get you very far

Though the ideas give you something
To hold there in your hand
Something you feel certain
That you can understand

At least you are one of many
You can't look dumb
They are all there standing with you
Backing you up
Reassuring you
Patting you on the fucking back
With their other hand
And holding onto empty hope
In the other

But you'd be absolutely nowhere
Without each other

When one oddball disagrees
You can look to each other
And shake your heads together
In ridiculous unison
Like the more of you do it
The more it matters

When you believe in something
And it's real
It's not just some rehearsed spiel
It's something that you absolutely
Completely through and through
Have no choice but to feel

People who have true inner peace
Tend to be quieter than those
Who just pretend to have it
They are less concerned
With finding it for others too

Finding someone who really
Believes in their God
Isn't all that easy to do

Much more common
Are the unsure groups
That want to be sure that you do

It's easy to see
How lost they become
In everyone else's faith
The more they concern themselves

With yours
The less they tend to have
Themselves

They are the emptiness
That fills these barren shelves

They have an empty heart to fill
With people like you
Who can't figure out how to do
What they do
When they pray
For everyone but themselves

That's a lot of other souls
To worry about and pray for
Lots of other people
Committing sins
That they will never
Have to pay for

At least not in the next life
Which must be far more important
Than this one

An Empty Box

I don't wear you on my finger
I like to let you wear off
Somewhere much deeper inside me
Deeper than anyone else has gone
A little deeper than I knew someone could

Love can be damaged
And it can die over time
But I can't just flush it away
And you could never kill mine

I don't wear you on one finger
With all the things you make me feel
You would never fit there

I'd rather keep you with me
The way you are
In the middle of some nights
When half of me is trying
To wake up from a bad dream
And I reach over
Or turn over
And feel some part of you
Then the rest of me
Can go back to sleep

We can break things
But we can be broken too
When people break
It's so much harder to ignore
And it won't stop
The scars that form
Relationships deform

Taking every little bit
Of something good
That might have been there
And leaving nothing in its place
When things break
They can always be replaced
With a new something
Just like the one before it
Almost as if it could be brand new

With people the only way to replace
Them once they break
Is to leave them behind
And find someone else

Does that make us easier
To replace or is it harder?

I think we are much harder
To fix up or repair

Like some things we've broken
We may seem fine
Even when the pain
Remains right there
Beneath our surface
Hurting just as much when
Left unspoken

Sometimes I wonder
If love really does exist
Between any two people
In a way that is real and true
And does no serious harm

There are moments when
I'm not sure that it's ever true
But those are moments
Where I doubt a lot of things
The rest of the time I am pretty sure
That it does exist out there
For some people in some situations

And I just feel like I am stuck
On the other side of it
For whatever reason
Like I might be forever
I think that's somehow better
Even if I never find it
Or don't look hard enough in
The right places

That thought bothers me less
Than having to accept
That it might always
End up being a lie after all

But I do know what I feel
Whether it makes sense or not
I guess we shouldn't expect it
To make any more sense
Than some of the things we do

But that doesn't mean
We haven't done them
Or that we don't feel
However we do

Maybe it's all I know for sure
When I tell you right now
That I love you

But if you love me too
As much as you say you do
Then there is no way
You could ever make it fit

In a box that small
And no way that I could
Ever make it fit
On only one finger

So give me a little box again
Sometime soon
But this time try to
Put some of your heart
Inside of it instead

Because if you really do it
And you mean it -
If it's really there
My face will light up
Even brighter
When I open it this time

That's all I want
In all this world
Just make sure you
Really do it and don't
Fake it
You can't give me
Something if it isn't
Really there for me
To take it

I love you forever
And you are with me
Everyday
All the time
Forever

No matter what happens
The ways you've changed me
Will always keep us together

Broken Dreams

You probably don't know
Half of the feelings I don't show

Don't want to bother someone
With my own painful stories
Don't know why I still let them bother me
But they do

Why do they still hurt
I think they always will

I'm trying not to fall apart
But it's hard not to follow my heart
When it breaks and falls apart first

Some parts of me still get mad
Screaming and demanding
Why this has been the life I've had
They just need some answer
All they ask is why

The past is ugly and dark and it's over
The damage is done

I can't find the answer because there isn't one

All I ever wanted was for someone else
To think I mattered
I'm never worth more than
Having my heart shattered

I was trying hard not to start crying
While I write this
And now the tears have started
And I can't stop them

They will go on and on until I'm tired
But I'll still be here alone
No one can come with me here
To where I hurt the most

Go Ahead

"Go Ahead..."
Try to take everything
That makes a person who they are
And reduce it down to nothing
Just because that's all there is

"Come On..."
Think of me as nothing more
Than the tears I cry,
The words I scream,
The stories that are told
By the scars across my soul

"Told You..."
That I loved you
To chase me if I ran away
And in the next breath
Told you how much I hated you
And taunted you
Because you kept returning

"I Called You..."
A faggot
An asshole
A psycho
But before any of that
I heard that first voicemail
And I called you back

"I'm Just Not..."
In love with you
But I do love you
I do care
But I'm not attracted to you
And that makes it
Not matter
How close we are as friends

I'm sorry

"I Won't..."
Move in with you
And be your girlfriend

I won't be a trophy
To show off to your friends

I won't fuck you everyday
Like I do today,
By the hour

I won't stop
Seeing other guys
Or getting high

I won't even answer you
I won't tell you
The truth
On my way out

I won't crush your little dream
I won't have the heart
To break yours apart

I won't come back
I won't be what you want if I do

"But Not..."
Another day of broken dreams
Sometimes sadness
Isn't as sad as it seems

But not this time
This time is mine
But not without you
Then I might have to be strong
But not right now
Don't have the patience
To learn how

"What About..."
All the times you told me
You would never use something
Against me
And then you did

What about how scared
I was at first
How you just walked
Right up to me
And how I withdrew
And hid

What about all those things
You promised that we'd do
That we never did

Eclipse

The world has been
Growing gradually darker
One shade at a time
Everything in it lost its color
A long time ago

Sometimes you'll find
The purest is the strongest,
Hardest to break kind of mind

Breaking down what's good
Bringing down around
As this broken mind breaks down

It's been taken one step too far
And now it can't find its way back
To where it used to be

Resting up just to wear down again
It's catching up to me
I can't keep up with it

It closes in coming at me rapidly
Now here I am
Ready for another run
Running right into the ground
Nursing that wound
And tearing it open again

Holding Hands

I'd like to get lost in your eyes
If it's okay with you
And if you wouldn't mind
Once I've lost myself again
I'd love to be yours there
In your wide eyes for you to find

And if you do find me there
Making my way through your stare
Would you guide me past
What can't be seen?

It turns out we are on our
Separate ways to the same place
Although it seems we are already there
Fitting together flawlessly
Some opposing, perfect pair
Of some breaking broken heart
Lit up by our spark

Our little chase, endless race
As fast as a heart that
Beats at love's pace

Right now it seems so impossible
That next time I see you again
Like every time I've seen you before
You'll be every bit as gorgeous
As I remember you
And just a little bit more

Thick and sticky center
Where only you can enter
Condensed and creamy core
Swirling around the you and me
That I fight for

Reeling at the thought of having more

Chaos In My Head
Ecstatic matches
Matched by magic
Echoes of ourselves
Of laughter fit to shake and shatter
The pain of the past that does not matter
Kills the dead eyes
Defeats the hardened heartless guise

I've been given the gift
The sacredness
From each of those parts of your love
That is captured perfectly
Inside there with you
And deep inside where no one can see
Dark little corners of me

Every time I get to this light it's red
Warning me of what's ahead
I only stop for it and speed up as it changes

There's chaos in my head
And my heart is breaking

My heart is broken

And when you needed those things the most
Caught up in the whirlwinds of panic and pain
You called upon them,
Imploring them each by their name
And every one of them failed you
Dying off like admirable soldiers of some
Army that had not what was needed
To be anything other than completely defeated

And that's where you are
In that halfway dead end pathway
Though they are innocent instruments
Of what took away our short-lived day
Here I still look for you and I'm
Sending it out to you
In screams for you

Behind each of your eyes
There lies the fire of matching miracles
If you're broken we can start here
With this first piece
It's a maze of amazing things

Feeble-flamed
Thought to have blown out
With the passing wind
Winding this way
Almost looks like new fire
Coming from nowhere
Sparked by no one
A light's little burn
Looms like a shadow
Of the lost blaze before it

Comes right back
Fierce-colored
Set against the black
Of only a moment ago
Some shooting star
Shot across this sky
You're its secret
It keeps you well
Safe from being known

This was for you

This fire splits in two
A showering of sparks
Like the liquid lava
That flows between our hearts

Inside of my head
It is just a flashing theatre
With light that never ends

Fight For It

It would just be too tragic
To throw away this kind of magic

It would be such a waste
To give up and stop this chase

Lately it's been kind of like
I am dying slowly
The gradual disintegration
That you've had to watch

Some days are better than others
Some days I feel okay
Then there are days that the pain
Comes in size defiant waves
These are the days that pass by
To a much slower moving clock
Its ticking-tocking ticks and tocks
Pour down on us in showers of shock

That is when the invisible invincibility
Half from you and half from me
Comes crashing into each other
Stuck together by some thick
Unbelievable kind of stick

That is how the orb is formed
The one that's high up there
And never stops moving
It glows just as warm as your skin
Just a little warmer than the skin
That covers me
Feeling like the perfect kind of heat

You tell me that same orb
Has fallen from where it hangs
Not like the shooting star we are
But like a comet colliding with the world
Ending in explosion
All the damage freezing frozen

Maybe you just can't see through your tears
They could just be blurring what is really there
Making it seem like fragmented
Scenes from bad dreams

If you really look up there and stare into it
You'd see that it burns like a liquid star

You are what I want most
And nothing else will ever do
If this slips away from me
I won't ever know the happiness

That I would have known with you

I want every moment for as far as I can see

To be this full of such fiery flame-licked intensity

Go To Sweet With Me

I have this memory from a long time ago
Middle of a fight

Was one of the times that my pain
Came out as rain pouring out
In an outpour of endless tears
Instead of being delivered in screams
And words I didn't mean
Aimed perfectly to hit where I knew
It would hurt most

Yet I wanted so badly to hold your heart
To keep it safe and protect it
What I know now that I didn't know then
Is that then I just didn't know how

I remember my face felt like
It was being washed away
Melting in the teary tidal wave
I know I was letting it flow
To let how badly I was hurting show

Most of the time I would run away and hide instead
Afraid of how much you could hurt me
Because of how much I loved you

Guarding myself with defenses
And reacting out of fear never really worked
But it seemed like all that I had
I think sometimes I was so afraid
Of losing you to something
I forgot that I had you

I remember trying to lock eyes with you
Yours were angry
Mine had been neglected
Like badly leaking faucets that someone should
Have fixed a long time before

It didn't matter if I tried to stop them
Each time they closed and re-opened
There was more
It was warm like bathwater
It could have gone on forever

I went looking for your attention
We had made a promise for moments like this one
And I had to say it
I needed it as badly as I needed
To find the calm after the storm that I was feeling

What I asked was simply that

You go to sweet with me

It wasn't easy to ask

I could see the struggles happening

All at once in your eyes

In your mind and in your heart

When you went to sweet with me

It didn't fix any of the things that we had broken

It didn't re-hang torn down poems

Or bring back tossed out rings

It couldn't undo what was done

It didn't take away the ghosts

You think they only visit you

But they come to see me too

Waking Up To You

It can't be taken back
It cannot be returned
It cannot ever be reversed
Little love drenched pools
In which we find ourselves immersed

Coming into focus as we
Skirt the edges of our trembling
Always starting to another ending

Storms that wordlessly seem
Here to stay

Lifting like the lightness of a storm
As its streaming and hardly there
Intersecting mesh like wisps of hair

If the world ends around us
We won't end with it

In Our Ruts

The sky is slurring
Whatever time it is has started blurring
Blown out of its proportions
By the starry distortions

They're the impulsive pulse
Of the heart that is in love with you
If it wasn't before then it is now
Don't you feel it coming true?

Like dreams dreamt every night
Of being forever and only with you
All the feelings fueling all these tears
Tremble as if about to drip

I seemed so stuck in my abysmal rut
But then I watched you
Fall into one of your own
And some of me came back
To bring you back out too

Get Over It

I have nothing to write
For you to read by the light
Of something barely burning

When you get over it let me know
Every time I hear from you
No matter what you say
The only thing I hear is
That you still care in some way

Whatever way
You care enough to say something

Like two children growing younger
Going backwards when they're together
Getting more and more lost
Long ago losing what's been
Lost forever

There isn't much left to even remember
That doesn't totally suck
You were just a fuck

But you're not even worth
Keeping around for that anymore

So what are you good for?
Not much anymore

I am free of loving you
Of caring about you
Of keeping you in my thoughts
And of letting you get to me

I am better without you in my world
You only make it darker and uglier
Which is why you no longer
Exist at all to me

Common Comforts

I've never found comfort
in common things or places
Where most other people find it

When I was younger and angrier
I liked to think that this meant
I was better than them
Of course that wasn't true
But when you're young and angry
What else can you do?

Now I realize that it just
Makes me lonelier than them

I don't want to get old
I'll have no one to
Grow there with me

And I don't want to watch
Me slowly lose myself
After being all I've ever had

I've been loud about
the wrong things that
People in my life have done
The less others care
The louder I get

I at least don't want them
to ever forget

I don't want to grow up
Nothing waits for me at the top

I've always taken it
Day by day
One adventure at a time
Going wherever life Takes me

Everyone else
Has set all these goals
Make this much money
In this much time
Move up the food chain this far

Have two and a half kids
and a white fence
around the yard where they play

And all of that is great

But what price do you pay?

I'd rather have fun and enjoy today
Than worry about the future

I figure for someone like me
Who doesn't want these things
I'm right in the middle of the
Best years I will ever have

There will be plenty of time later
For second guessing
for loneliness
and even regret

Right now I can't set myself up
For any of those things
It would be such a waste
of both time and energy

It Isn't Over

It isn't over
The sunlight doesn't lie

Sometimes you just have to
Go along with being gorgeous
Because you are

Just ride it out
Radiantly and fair
Wearing waterproof
Sunscreen war paint
Beneath your eyes

No more fighting
That smile
It's a crime
You've gotta let yourself
Be divine
Because you are

It isn't over

So stop writing it off
While you still have it

It's still very much there
Still totally yours

Forget everyone else
Because this is about yourself
And you are so much better
Than they will ever be

Strong willed and once wild
In full bloom magnificene
And then raining back down
On the starving world

It isn't over
Not even close

Nothing trying to
Pass for beautiful
That isn't
Can ever stand the test
Bodies walking the Earth
Who aren't human
Always stand out for
What they are

From a distance
They may fool the eye
But as they get closer
A lie is exposed
The truth is revealed
Their snake's skin sheds

The illusion evaporates

You are not that
And it is not over

The ugliest of things
Choose the most convincing disguises

But not beauty

Not your kind, at least
Not only do you
Hold a candle
But that candle's light
Is you

High Dive

I feel just like I did
Standing paralyzed
On the high dive,
As a kid
All eyes on me
As I shift between
Determination and terror

Except for this time around
it is us that I'm about to
Jump into
And yes, I still feel
the alternating currents
Of excitement and fear

I keep coming back
To the same questions
In my head
What if it's the sex we love
Rather than each other?

Can loving that
Grow into something more?

But then I realize
That it already has
I've always kept love
So separate from sex
Perhaps they don't always
Exist so independently
From one another

If you meet me in the middle,
There is nothing I won't do
To make this work,
To make you happy,
To make this dream come true

I never did jump from
The high dive that day

But now I'm ready
Because this time
You jumped first
And I know you're
Waiting for me below

The Anger

I learned early on to
Never ask for love
For fear of those closest refusing

Leave me alone,
I'll hold onto this anger for you
It will keep me safe from you too

I'm sorry, this is the only way
I know how to react
To these things you make me feel
Always trying so hard
To pretend I don't care
That I begin to think it's real

Where are the words
Or the understanding
That can make everything okay?
I seem to share my deepest secrets
Yet you don't seem to know what to say

I can't really blame you for that
I don't know what to say to them either

Defensive makes sense
When you're on your own team
And no one has your back

I feel damaged
And broken
Like I can't get over it
It keeps me from
Feeling close to you
Or anyone at all

So I push you away
When all I want
Is for you to be close
I'm scared you won't be there
And I know the pain
That will take your place
If you aren't

Surrendering
Just doesn't seem smart
My anger is my pain
See it for what it is
It was the only thing
That kept me safe
And so I cling to it

Why let them see you cry
If they don't care
Use the anger as a mask
Even if it's all a lie

Every time I think you
Don't want me
I begin to fall apart
All over again

But I can't promise
To warm up to your touch
Even if you try to be
Gentle and make amends

You have to be strong,
Steady, and better than me
Or all of this will end
Miserably

My Immortality

These words are
My immortality
Somewhat empty;
A reflection of
My personality

I'm afraid that
This is as good as it gets
I've left exactly no room
In my experience
For regrets

I will accept things
Wherever they may
End up ending
Anyone who claims
Complete perfection
Wasted life pretending

There is nothing to win
In this life;
There is no prize
Everyone ends up
In the same place;
Everyone dies

No matter your accomplishments
We are all fast forgotten
Why is the nothingness
That is Death
So very terrifying to us?
I guess because this life is
All we've ever known

We came from nothing
We will return back to it
It's just the memories in between
That don't survive
Hard fact to swallow
Since without them
We don't know who we are

Maybe we are no one
And everyone
Both, at the same time
Just one consciousness
Returning in the guise of
Someone else

Worthless

I love how you get in my head
And all the way under my skin
The way you carefully peel back
Each layer of who I am,
Following the nerve pathways
Of my brain to revisit the memories
They contain
Becoming inextricably tangled up
In all my past suffering and abuse

You exorcise all my inner demons
Until you've taken their places,
Becoming the only one left

You feel a little bit drunk
On this new level of power
You now have over me
I mean less than nothing to you
Yet the love I feel for you
Burns blindingly
It pounds like a drum being played
To the rhythm of a heartbeat
It flutters in my chest like
Monarch butterflies trapped in a net
It spasms involuntarily
Just as naturally as I breathe or blink

My feelings for you have
Healed so many parts of me
In those moments of intensity
I almost feel it washing over me
A lifetime of pain just melts away

Acceptance is the truest path
To liberation and peace
To think, all I ever actually had to do
Was stop fighting myself,
Listen to others,
Stop denying that everything
They told me was true

No one has ever wanted or loved me,
And no one ever will
I have never deserved to be
Worth anything to anyone

Any gifts or talents that I
Started out with,
I have thrown away
Just like my mother did to me
Abandoning me the moment
She first saw me
In my newborn infancy
Giving birth to me was an instant
And lifelong regret

Please, hurt me
Abuse me
Inflict your scorn upon me
Punish me for breathing
Break whatever parts of me
That seem too complete

Sweet Little Bub

Suddenly the days feel
impossibly long
Each hour stretching on and on
My time no longer punctuated
By the joy and meaning you
Brought to my life

Now serving a run on sentence of misery
That nothing can fix,
Improve,
Or even numb

I was always totally aware
Of the inescapable fact
That I loved you too much

You were the source of all my happiness
My only true comfort
In the face of so much ugliness
And pain
You were the only reason
It was worth enduring
And I have nothing left
To cry for
To want
To need
Nothing left in this world
To make me feel so close to complete

All my pain has finally
Caught up to me
It came crashing around the corner
like an angry ocean wave
The first of many more to follow
Soon working together
Slowly flooding this cave

So much pain that I
Sink right into it
Like a quicksand
I lose my mind inside of it too suddenly
To even capture my suffering in any words

Maybe I'll just get behind the wheel of my car
Leave without saying a single word
Just drive and drive
And see how far
Don't know where I'd go
Not even sure it matters
Now it's just a thing that I could do
Covering all those meaningless miles
As what's left of who I was
Completely shatters

I've only ever kept a precious few
Close enough to know me
I do so struggle with the distribution
Of the love I have to give to others
Giving some to one person
Always seems to take away
From some other's

Is it even supposed to work that way?

Because while it does seem wrong,
I also know that my love
Is not an endless well
That can forever go on
replenishing itself

Could it be that in giving it away
To those I have chosen
Always leaves me with none
For myself

How did I get here

My heart has so many
holes in it

That the whole thing
has become one itself

A grave dug for me
where it used to be

This deafening silence
I suffer in
Without your voice
To fill it

I miss the trouble you caused me
Every little inconvenience
I'd trade my freedom for it
Without a second thought

Small Town Life

These are not cities anyone knows
by name
They are forgettable spots,
The kind where you get lost
On your way to better places

You have to be born there
To be part of the club
Leery of outsiders,
They only trust the people
They have lived their entire
Little lives around
And that's just how they like things

Their existence has no room
for ideas bigger than
the nameless places
that they are born and die in

No tolerance for anyone
who sees beyond their
daily mundane
journey to the grave

Who the hell wants to live
on a beach anyway?

Someone who wants to drown
in the next tsunami wave,
I suppose

Of course,
that's assuming that the
static state of time
in such a place
doesn't kill you first

Screeching Modem

The screeching sound
Of an old modem
Strikes such a deep chord
Of nostalgia within me
Like a bass guitar
Full of vibrations

Now obsolete,
It was once the entrance
To the rest of the world:
We called it the internet
It was still new and fantastic
While at the same time,
Dreadful and nascent
And filled mostly with clutter

This era was ruled by AOL
America Online something dot number
I had started around 4.0
Their magical discs were
Literally everywhere

Every store had bins
Filled with them
Like a candy dish
In a waiting room
And you could use them

For a free trial
That was almost always extended
Each time you tried to cancel it

Seemed so glorious at that time
They just kept giving away
The internet
And I kept coming back

Eventually they lost their hold
People got sick of sacrificing
Their phone lines for the sake
Of being online
These people were usually parents

Next came DSL
It was faster supposedly
I can't say I truly know
What made it so different
My parents eventually
Got a second line
So they could use the phone again

Around this time came
Napster and Kazaa
With peer-to-peer file sharing
Also known as digital piracy
Platforms for downloading

Everything from mp3 tracks
To porn videos
All for free
And almost always illegally

You can have whatever opinion
You want on this topic
But no matter your take on all of it,
The guys who ran the Pirate Bay
Were some badass motherfuckers

As cool as this was,
The internet was not yet
Impressive in its speed or
Its file availability
So unless the song you wanted
Was very popular and had been
Shared among many users,
It could take days to fully download
Sometimes even longer

Of course instant messaging
Was all the rage around this time
There was Yahoo,
And MSN,
And while AOL was losing
Its monopoly as the
service provider of the web,
AIM was still perhaps the most
Popular messaging service around

The old AOL chatrooms
I had started out in
Were no longer accessible
But the long distance friendships
That had been started in them
Continued seamlessly through
Daily instant messages
Sent back and forth
Between the small coastal town
Where I lived in Oregon
And cities like Atlanta and St. Louis

I Have Followed You

No one has ever been
so beautiful
In my entire life

No one has been anything
like you have

You gave me courage,
A gift every bit as priceless
As it was made out to be

But one that had never
Been given to me

You are strength,
Standing strong like you do
Caring about those like us,
And to hell with everyone else

You are the good,
the best
Parts of me,
myself

Something about you
Wouldn't let me give up
Kept me coming back

For more rejection
Whether you meant to or not
You forced me to grow
To think hard about myself

You were my turn
To be turned down

Bruised my confidence
Reminded me that I can't just
Have whoever I want
You weren't interested
So I realized that was okay

It didn't matter in the end
You didn't have to be
It made you no less special,
No less important;
Maybe even more intense for me

It was quite simply
Bigger than both of us
I didn't have to have you
You had already left
One of the deepest impressions
Across who I am,
Who I was,
Who I want to be

Nothing could change that
It was enough that you
Smiled back at me
Squeezed my hand,
So to speak
Made sure to let me know
That you were out there
And that you saw me

I could live with that
I could be happy with that even
But somewhere deep in my mind
I just absolutely knew
Together we could fucking
Take over the world
If we wanted to

I had to keep trying
To get as close
As you would let me
I had to see you
Before you left
Or you might just
Forget me

Don't be scared of me
I'd do things for you
I never thought I'd ever do
Because it's me who is
The lucky one in this

You are the first time
Someone's else's happiness
Makes me happier than mine

Let me love you
How I always have
The way I've always wanted to
I'll wait for you
As long as it takes
Until you tell me
It's time
We're made of the same stuff
And this love is fused
To who I am
Whether or not you stay mine